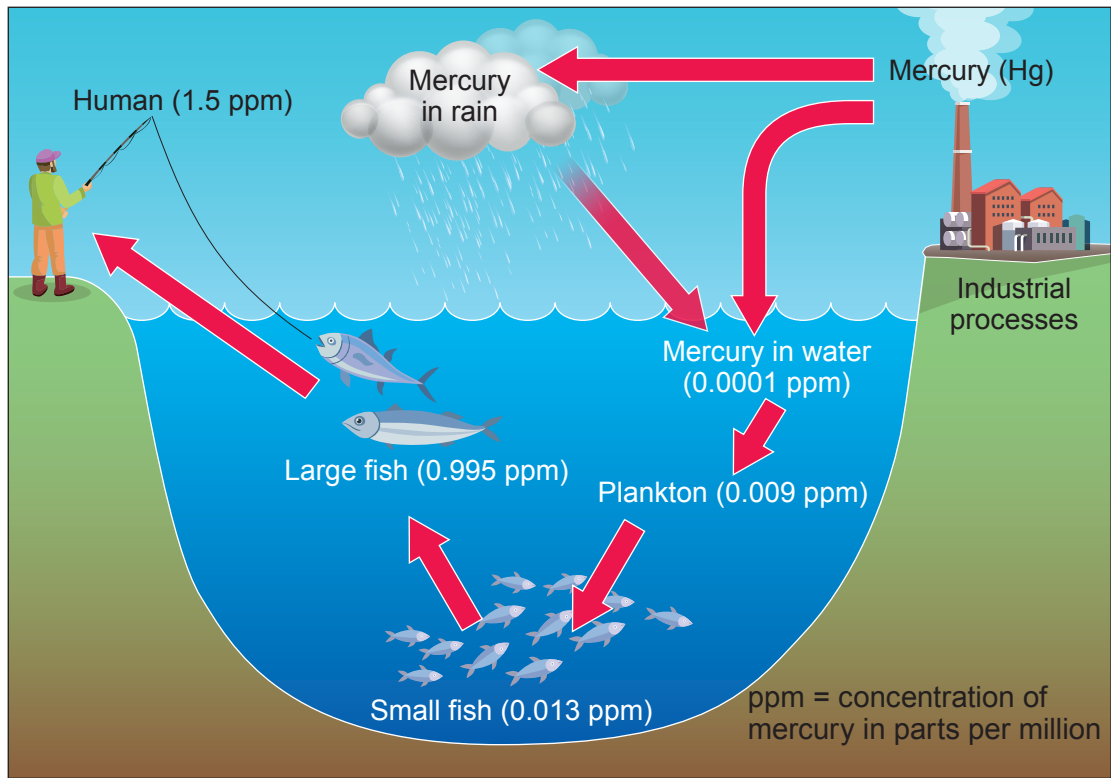


8. The United Nations Minamata Convention on Mercury is a global treaty to protect human health and the environment from the toxic effects of the heavy metal mercury.

In 2010, combustion of fossil fuels by industrial processes produced 24% of the total global emissions of mercury. **Image 8.1** shows how this mercury is cycled in the environment.

Image 8.1



- (a) (i) Calculate the percentage increase in mercury from the plankton to humans.
Give your answer to two significant figures.

[3]

Percentage increase =



Examiner
only

(ii) Using **Image 8.1** and your own knowledge, explain how the mercury released during the combustion of fossil fuels by industrial processes becomes harmful to humans. [3]

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(b) Apart from reducing mercury pollution, explain how reducing the combustion of fossil fuels can benefit the environment. [1]

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